

Syed Mohammad Ammar

Senior Product Designer

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PROFILE

Senior Product Designer with a Computer Science background and 5+ years of experience across fintech, marketplaces, and digital products. Works at the intersection of product design and design engineering, taking complex experiences from research and interaction design through production-ready React and Next.js implementation. Led product experiences serving **20,000+ clients** and built systems that reduced design-to-development handoff time by **35%**.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Practice

Jan 2023 – Present

Freelance Product Designer

- Designed core marketplace experiences for **Quest**, an AI-first services platform, across profiles, offers, booking, payments, wallet, and notifications while contributing directly to its React/Next.js web application.
- Helped reposition and rebrand Quest around people and AI agents hiring humans for real-world tasks; redesigned its public website and migrated the experience from **WordPress to Next.js**.
- Modernized a legacy **Clarion-based product** during its migration to **React, Next.js, and Tailwind CSS**, translating established workflows into modern web interfaces and contributing directly to frontend polish and responsive implementation.
- Designed and built Indochina Production Company's trophy showcase in Framer, owning the experience from interface design through development and launch.

Mahaana (YC W22)

Digital wealth platform offering savings, investments, and retirement products to 20,000+ active clients.

Senior Product Designer

Apr 2025 – May 2026

- Led product design across **iOS, Android, and web**, partnering with the founder, product, and engineering teams on product decisions while mentoring a junior designer.
- Built a shared design system of reusable components, design tokens, and interaction states across four platforms with light and dark themes, reducing design-to-development handoff time by **35%**.
- Migrated the marketing website from Webflow to **Next.js** and integrated **Sanity CMS**, owning design and frontend implementation while saving **\$600 annually** in hosting costs and enabling marketing to publish independently.

Product Designer

Dec 2023 – Apr 2025

- Redesigned onboarding and KYC to enable account opening in **under 5 minutes**, using usability testing to simplify risk profiling and replace manual identity entry with card capture.
- Turned risk-profile answers into adjustable investment allocations and brought first-investment selection into onboarding, reducing friction between account setup and investing.
- Created a portfolio dashboard that unified total value, returns, and product-level risk across savings and investment products; also designed Discover to combine market data, education, and an AI assistant for first-time investors.

EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

PeerDrop

UI/UX Designer

May 2021 – Aug 2022

Grocery-delivery marketplace connecting customers with local shoppers and delivery partners.

- Designed the mobile marketplace experience end-to-end, creating user flows, sitemaps, and final UI with business and engineering; the beta reached **1,000+ users**.
- Conducted user interviews and translated findings into revised order-acceptance flows and interaction improvements.
- Reduced production time by **17%** by building a design system with reusable UI components and consistent interaction patterns.
- Created the pitch narrative and product walkthroughs used in fundraising, supporting a successful **£40,000 investment round**.

SELECTED PROJECT

Iconimate

Motion Design & Frontend Development

2026 – Present

Open-source library of hand-timed animated React icons based on Phosphor. [iconimate.app](#) | [github.com/smammar100/iconimate](#)

- Designed and developed **216 animated React icons**, packaged for individual installation through the shadcn CLI.
- Built the live gallery so designers and developers could preview motion behavior before integrating icons into a product.
- Reached **45 GitHub stars** and was featured by **DEV.to** on social media.

SKILLS

Product & strategy: Product design, UX strategy, interaction design, information architecture, product discovery, user flows, prototyping, roadmap collaboration

Research & leadership: User interviews, usability testing, design systems, stakeholder collaboration, cross-functional facilitation, mentorship, design QA

Design engineering: React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Sanity CMS, Framer, GitHub

Design & AI tools: Figma, Cursor, Claude

EDUCATION

Harbour.Space / UTCC

MSc, Interaction Design | **Full scholarship**

Sep 2022 – Aug 2023

FAST-NUCES

BSc, Computer Science

Aug 2016 – May 2020

RECOGNITION

Winner, Freepik AI Day Challenge (Day 24) | The Nest I/O incubation alumnus